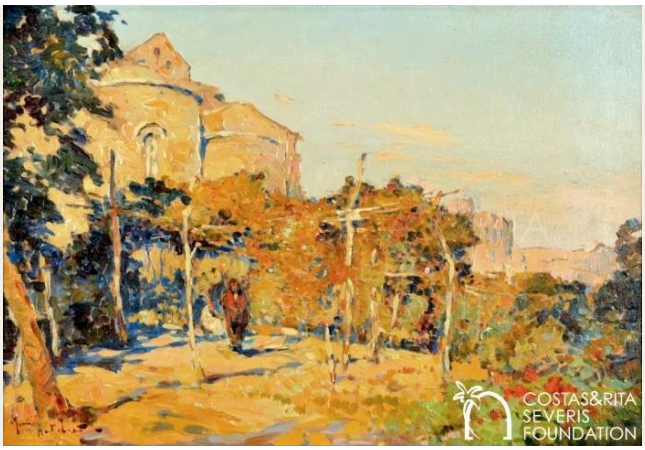
NICOSIA, CYPRUS

Centre of Visual Arts and Research: Masterpieces

Harbours, plants, monuments and sketches in the Centre of Visual Arts and Research collection, Nicosia.



A harbour store, a flowering stem and a quickly drawn statue record Cyprus at very different scales. This selection from Nicosia's Centre of Visual Arts and Research brings them together without asking them to provide a single, complete image of the island. Some works preserve named buildings; others give only a broad location. Several have no securely identified artist.

Captions matter particularly here. A written place and date can anchor a watercolour in a journey, while a traveller's historical label may require correction. The pictures are evidence of how particular people looked and recorded, not transparent windows onto an unchanged Cyprus. Read the image and its accompanying words as related but distinct records.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/cvar-nicosia

The selection · 20

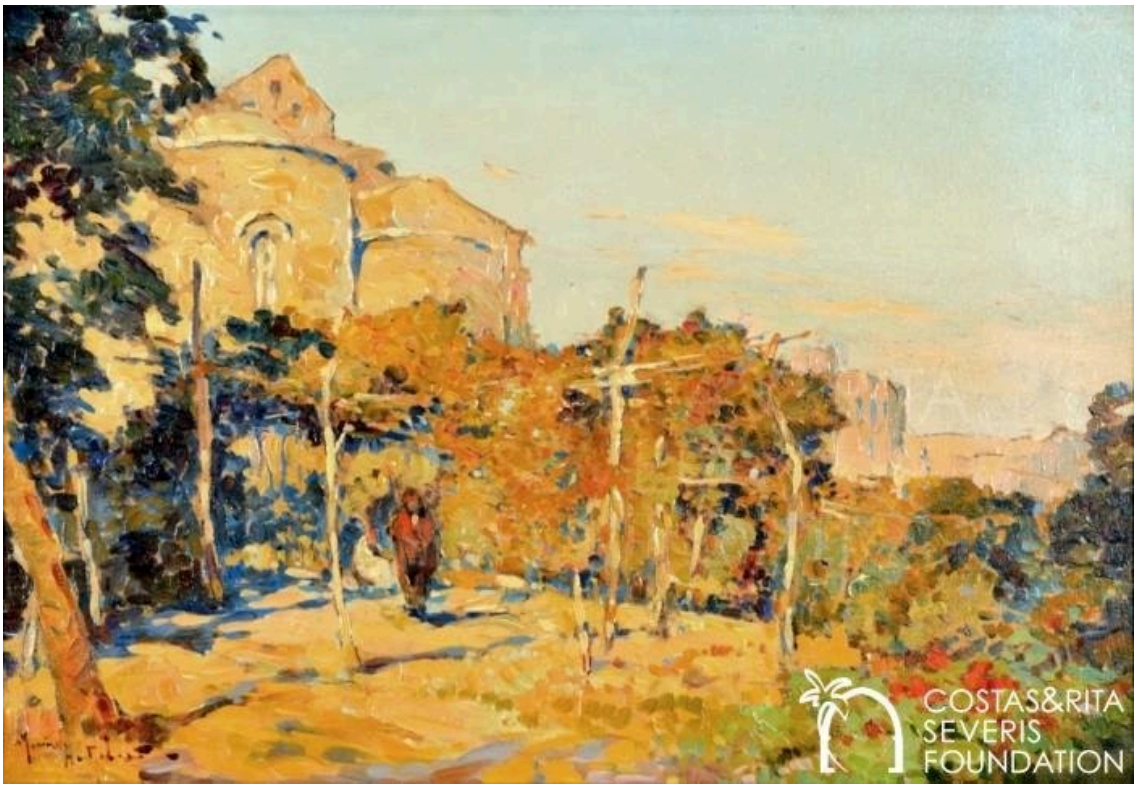
1. Saint George Xorinos, Famagusta
   Martin Henry Robert · c. 1930
2. Portrait of Mrs Razzini
   Anonymous · c. 1889
3. Salt Lake, Cyprus
   Charlotte Artizzone · c. 1950
4. Trees at Platres
   Anonymous · c. 1950
5. Carob Stores in Kyrenia Harbour
   Catherine Betty Crawford · 1933
6. From Pedoulas
   Catherine Betty Crawford · 1933
7. View towards Agia Irini Bay and Morphou
   Esmé Scott-Stevenson · c. 1879
8. A Male Figure
   Léon Bakst · 1921
9. Ancient Artefact
   Léon Bakst · 1921
10. Ancient Female Statue
    Léon Bakst · 1921
11. Cyprus: Shaving a Priest
    Anonymous · c. 1840
12. Salt Lake, Larnaca, with Stavrovouni
    Allan E. Balfour · 1938-03-09
13. The Lighthouse, Kyrenia
    Allan E. Balfour · 1938-03-05
14. Bellapais Abbey
    Allan E. Balfour · 1938-03-01
15. Flowers
    Catherine Betty Crawford · 1933
16. Kyrenia
    T. H. Pritchard · c. 1925
17. Ruins at Amathus
    Anonymous [Pars?] · 18th century
18. The Mosque at Famagusta
    Francis Arundale · 1833
19. View from a Wooded Hilltop, Cyprus
    Unknown artist · c. 1900
20. Ancient Statue
    Léon Bakst · 1921

01 / 20

Saint George Xorinos, Famagusta

Martin Henry Robert

c. 1930 · Oil on canvas · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The church rises behind trees and cultivated ground, so its stone walls belong to a setting still occupied by growth and use. Paths keep the foreground connected to the building. The view records more than a monument's outline: it preserves a particular arrangement around the monument, which should not be assumed to survive unchanged.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00001

02 / 20

Portrait of Mrs Razzini

Anonymous

c. 1889 · Oil on board · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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A name has survived for the sitter, though not for the painter. Her dark dress and light trim make the pose legible against the pale ground; the hands settle near the waist. That is enough for a close portrait description. It does not supply a profession, family history or temperament for Mrs Razzini.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00023

03 / 20

Salt Lake, Cyprus

Charlotte Artizzone

c. 1950 · Oil on canvas · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The lake and sky spread in pale horizontal bands, interrupted by slender palms and stems. Those uprights help measure the openness without filling it. The sparse description is especially useful here: adding equal detail everywhere would make it harder to register the extent of the water and the distance between its edges.

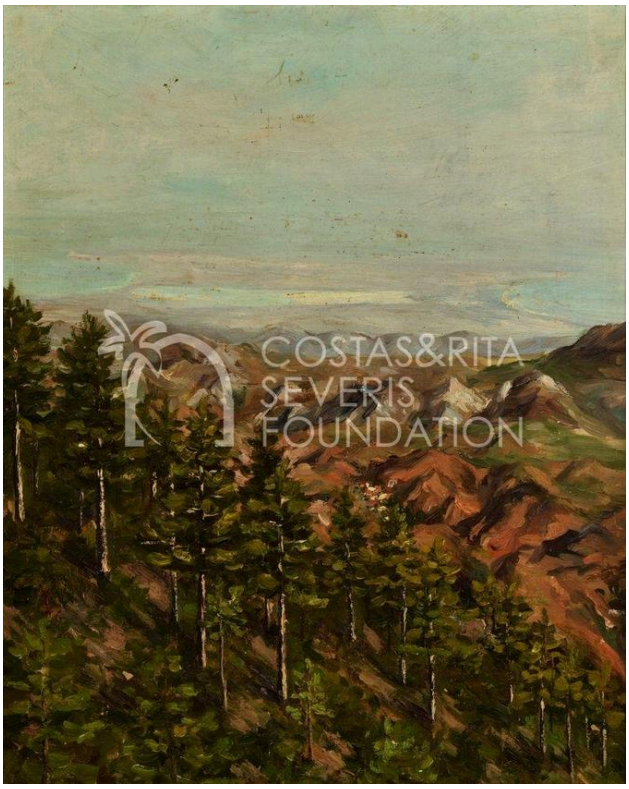
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00040

04 / 20

Trees at Platres

Anonymous

c. 1950 · Oil on board · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The descending slope is understood through changes in the density of trees. Darker trunks hold the near ground while hills carry the view farther away. An anonymous landscape can still preserve a specific spatial arrangement. The absence of an artist's name is a gap in its record, not a reason to invent a traveller behind it.

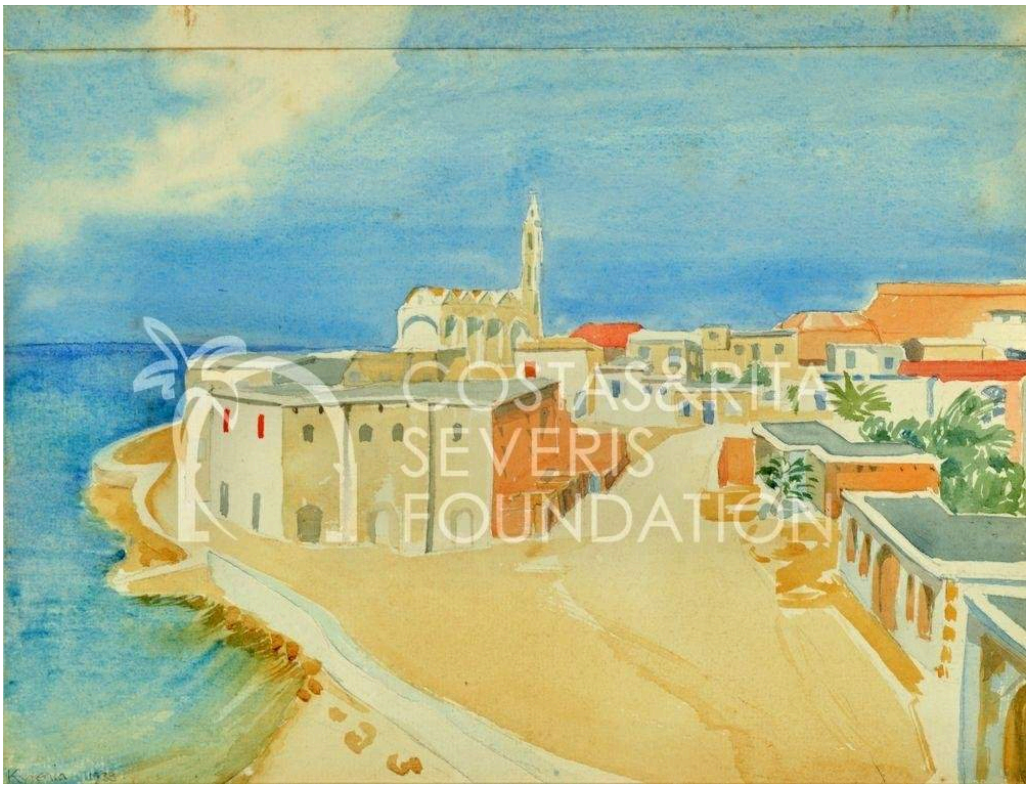
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00028

05 / 20

Carob Stores in Kyrenia Harbour

Catherine Betty Crawford

1933 · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The broad quay and waterfront stores give the harbour a working edge. Following the curve of the shore connects the buildings to the water they face. The title identifies carob storage, directing attention to an economic use that an attractive harbour view can otherwise make easy to overlook.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00007

06 / 20

From Pedoulas

Catherine Betty Crawford

1933 · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The place named in the title is represented by flowering stems rather than an extensive view. Branching joints, leaves and blossoms remain separate on the open sheet. This is another scale of travel record: a location may be remembered through something studied close at hand, without being reduced to a panorama or landmark.

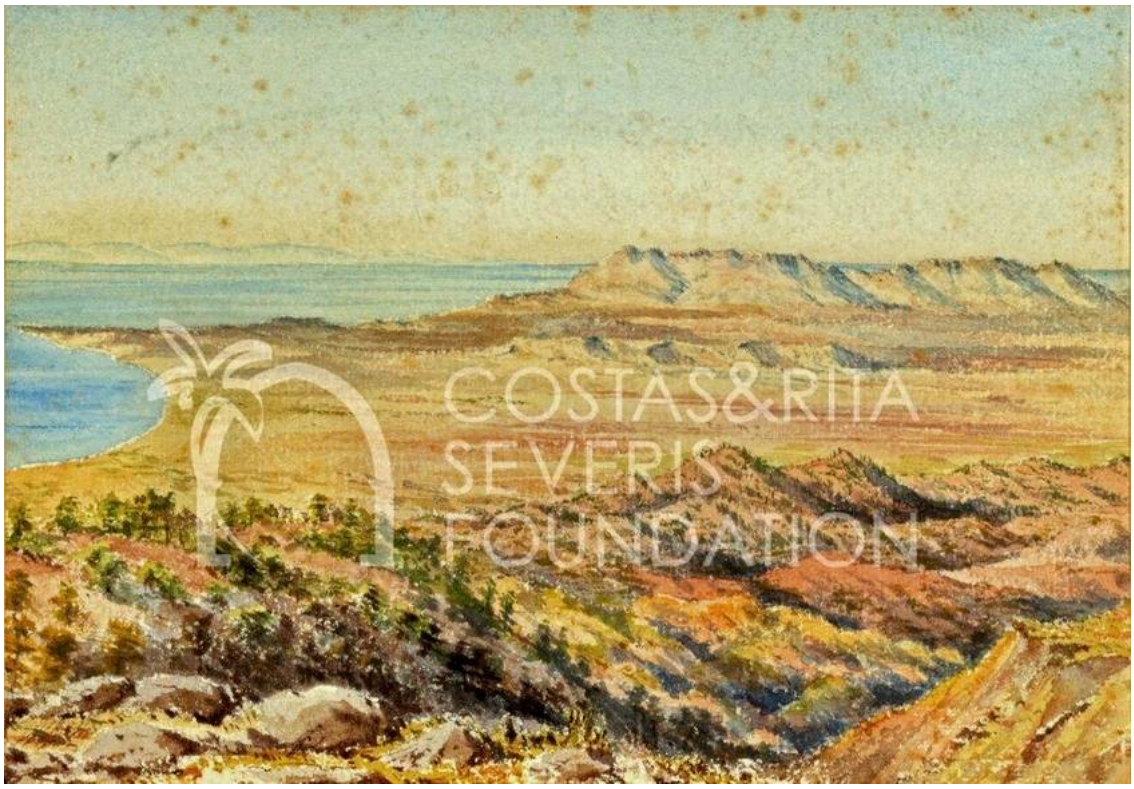
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00013-01

07 / 20

View towards Agia Irini Bay and Morphou

Esmé Scott-Stevenson

c. 1879 · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The high viewpoint arranges the land in successive distances: rough ground nearby, ridges farther out and the coastal plain leading toward the sea. The foreground gives the broad bands a physical scale. It is a view selected from a particular position, not a neutral map of all the territory named in its title.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00006

08 / 20

A Male Figure

Léon Bakst

1921 · Pencil · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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A bent arm and a few folds give the lightly drawn body its organisation. The unfinished head and absent setting leave attention on the pose. There is little basis for identifying an emotion or an occasion. The drawing is useful precisely as a selective record, showing how few relations are needed to make a standing figure legible.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00043-12

09 / 20

Ancient Artefact

Léon Bakst

1921 · Pencil · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The object's profile occupies only a small part of the sheet. Darker strokes distinguish one side, but the drawing does not provide the archaeological context that would identify its original use. Keeping the broad museum title respects that limit. A careful outline and an uncertain identification can coexist in the same record.

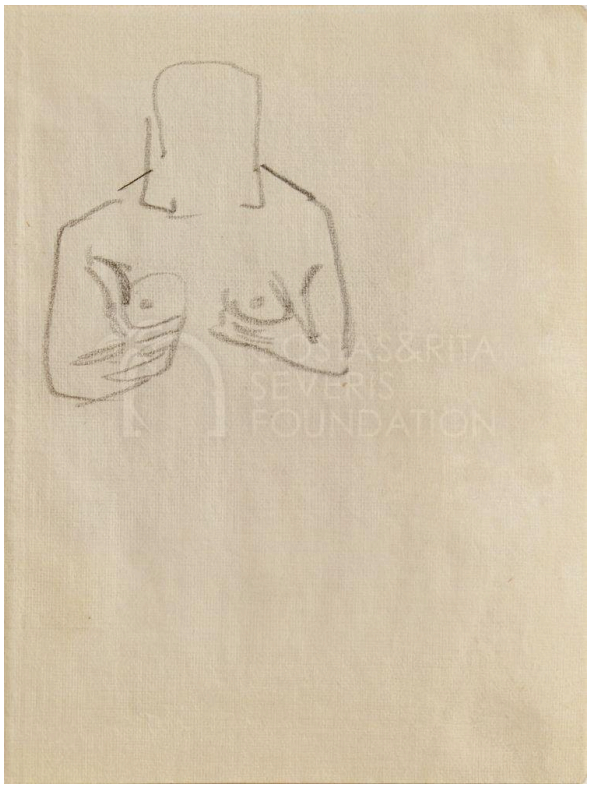
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00043-02

10 / 20

Ancient Female Statue

Léon Bakst

1921 · Pencil · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The bent arms and hands near the chest repeat across the frontal torso, while the head receives less definition. Bakst selects a bodily arrangement from a sculptural object instead of supplying an exhaustive copy. That economy makes the drawing useful for comparing forms, though it cannot replace the fuller evidence of the statue itself.

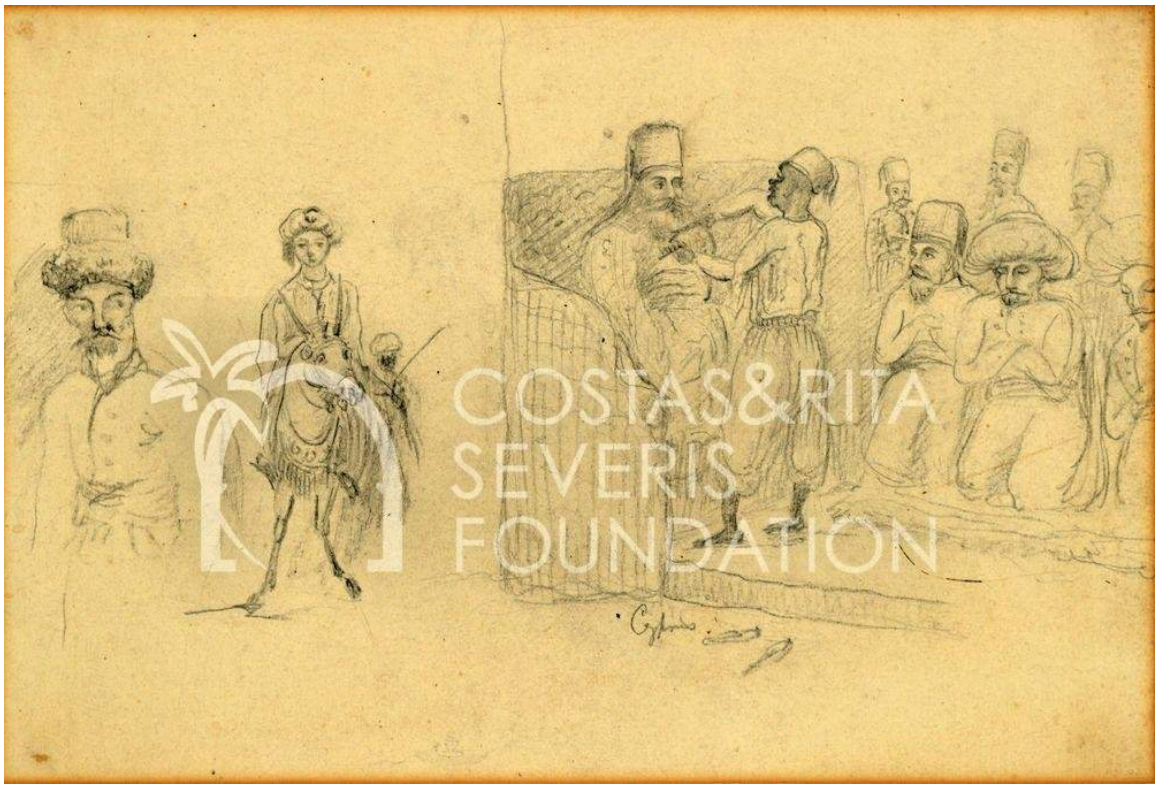
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00043-05

11 / 20

Cyprus: Shaving a Priest

Anonymous

c. 1840 · Pencil drawing · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The seated man is surrounded by other figures rather than isolated as the subject of a portrait. The caption identifies the service being performed; the loose interior and nearby objects leave much of its setting unresolved. The sheet records a social situation, but cannot establish every participant's identity or the exact circumstances of their meeting.

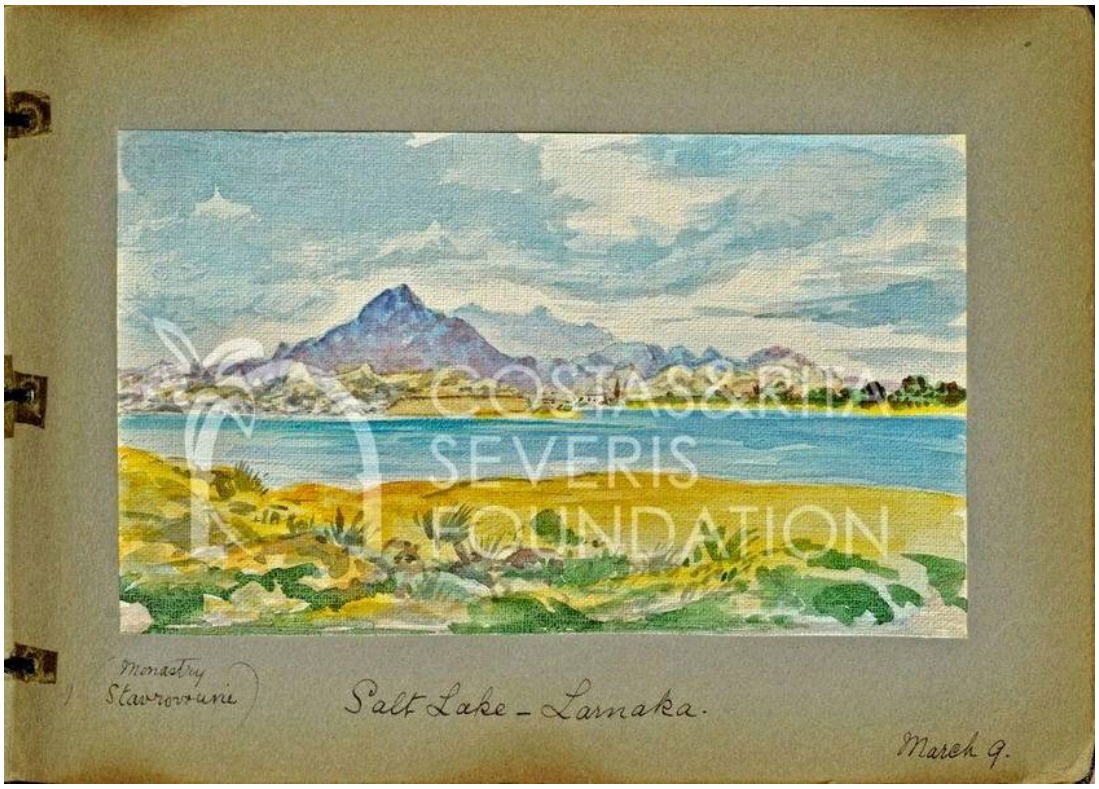
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00009

12 / 20

Salt Lake, Larnaca, with Stavrovouni

Allan E. Balfour

1938-03-09 · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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Water and a distant mountain occupy the view, while the inscription fixes a place and a day: 9 March 1938. Image and caption do different jobs. One arranges the visible distances; the other locates this stop in a sequence of travel. Together they make the watercolour more specific than a general impression of Cyprus.

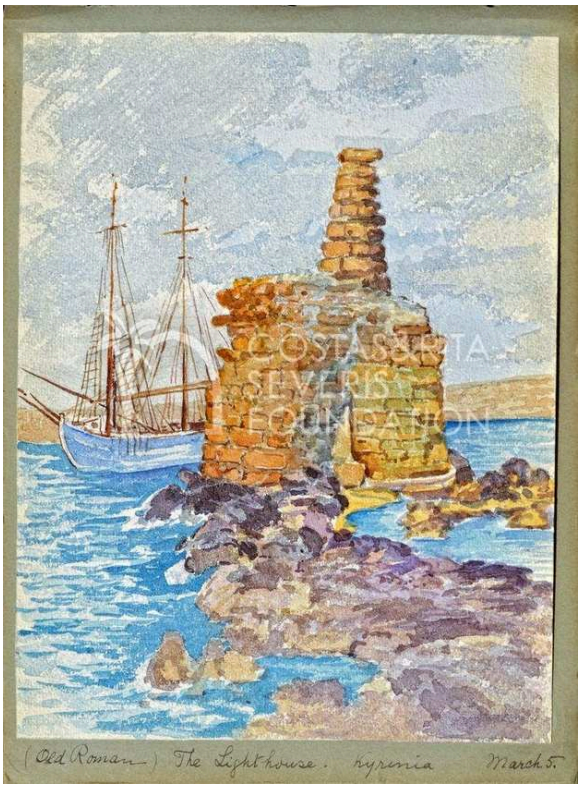
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00044-21

13 / 20

The Lighthouse, Kyrenia

Allan E. Balfour

1938-03-05 · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The tower is brought close enough for its masonry to register against the water, with a sailing vessel extending the harbour beyond it. Balfour's historical caption is part of the record, but its reference to an “old Roman” lighthouse should not be accepted as an archaeological dating. A traveller's label preserves an understanding, not necessarily a verified fact.

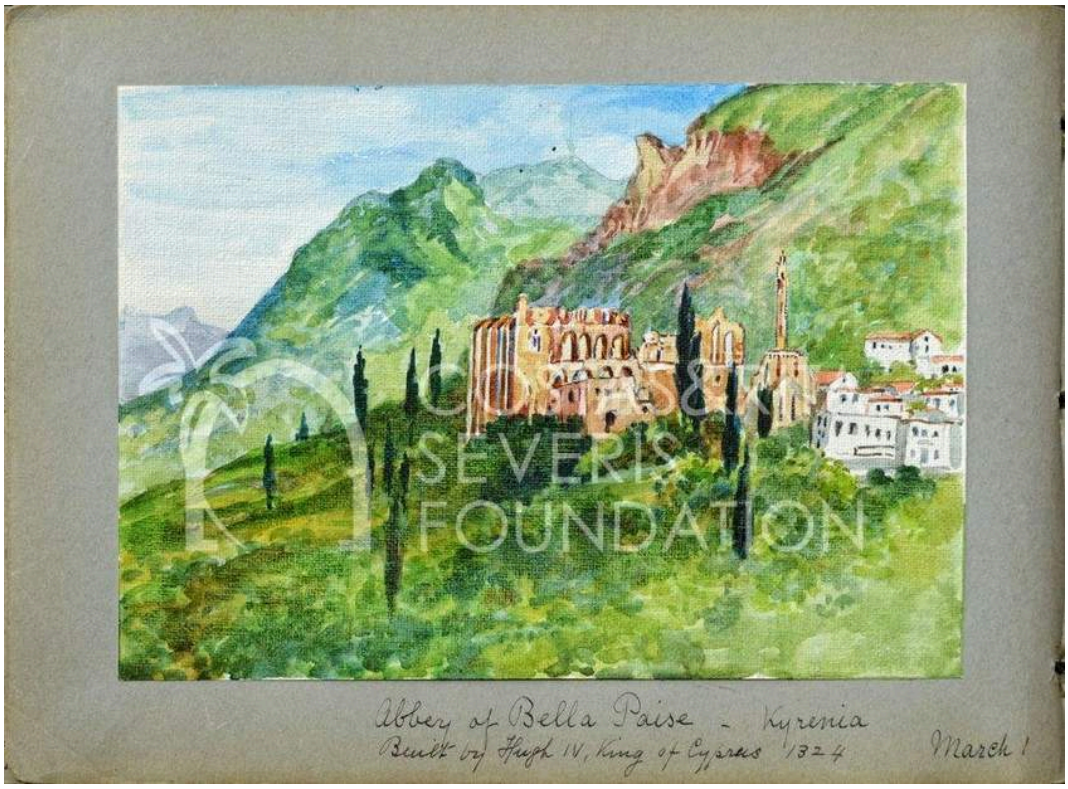
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00044-10

14 / 20

Bellapais Abbey

Allan E. Balfour

1938-03-01 · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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Trees and the green slope surround the ruined arches, placing the abbey within a larger terrain. The mounted caption records Balfour's visit and his historical understanding of the site. Those are separable matters: the picture can establish how he represented the building without confirming every statement written beneath it.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00044-28

15 / 20

Flowers

Catherine Betty Crawford

1933 · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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Open flowers, buds and leaves give different stages of growth a place on one branching stem. The pale background keeps each junction available for examination. Unlike a bouquet arranged as a solid mass, this study relies on the spaces between parts, allowing a small plant to occupy the sheet without losing its individual structures.

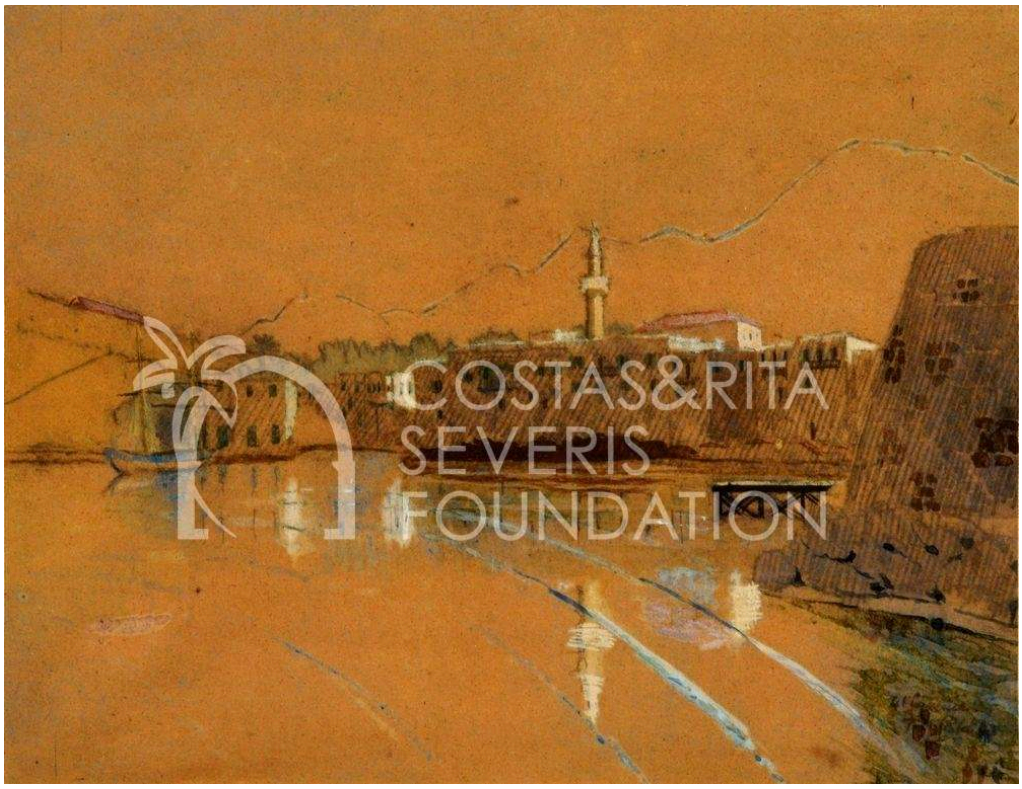
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00013-06

16 / 20

Kyrenia

T. H. Pritchard

c. 1925 · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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Fine lines establish buildings and masts while reflections carry some of their verticals into the water. The warm paper remains visible between the marks, contributing colour without a separate wash in every area. The harbour is therefore assembled partly through what is left untouched, rather than through an evenly filled surface.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00017

17 / 20

Ruins at Amathus

Anonymous [Pars?]

18th century · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The irregular border encloses ruins, trees and small figures, with mountains opening beyond them. The museum's tentative association with Pars remains uncertain and should not become a confident signature in retelling. That qualification does not prevent discussion of the composition, where the human scale is held within a much larger landscape.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00025

18 / 20

The Mosque at Famagusta

Francis Arundale

1833 · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The Gothic building and its minaret occupy the same skyline. Their conjunction makes architectural change visible without requiring the earlier form to have disappeared. Small figures and lower structures keep the site inhabited rather than treating it as an isolated specimen. The watercolour records a particular historical view, not the site's present appearance.

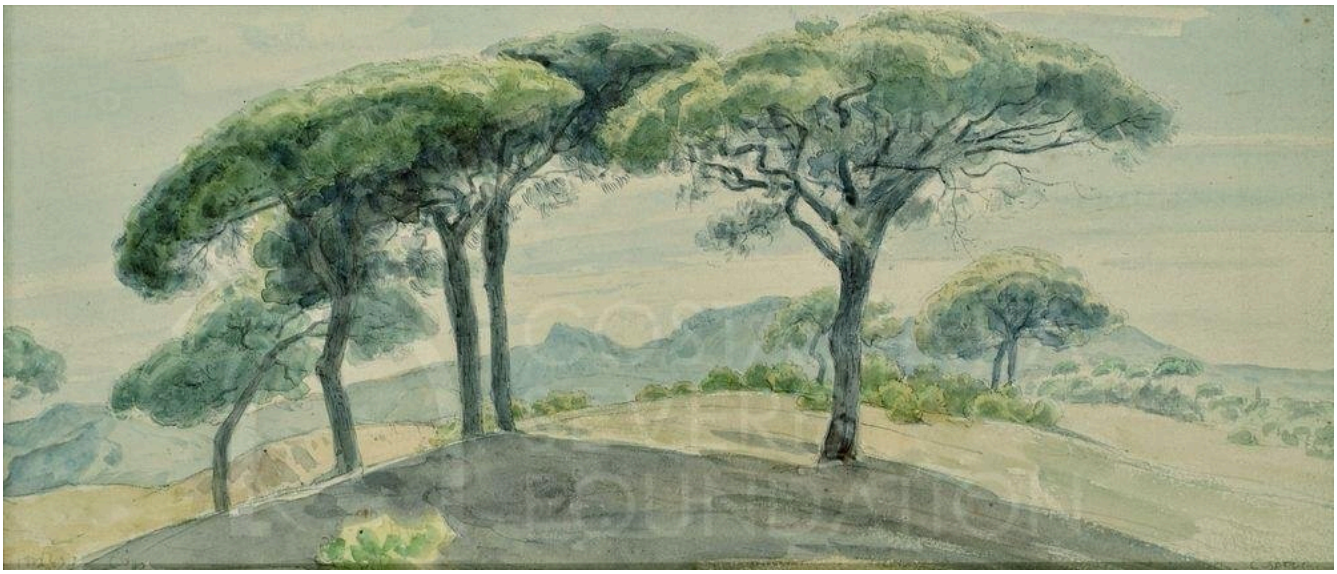
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00041

19 / 20

View from a Wooded Hilltop, Cyprus

Unknown artist

c. 1900 · Watercolour · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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The trees' broad crowns provide the strongest shapes across the sheet; thinner trunks hold them above the low ground. Their spacing makes the hilltop recognisable as a place with intervals and openings rather than a continuous mass of green. The unknown artist's identity remains separate from what this arrangement allows the image to show.

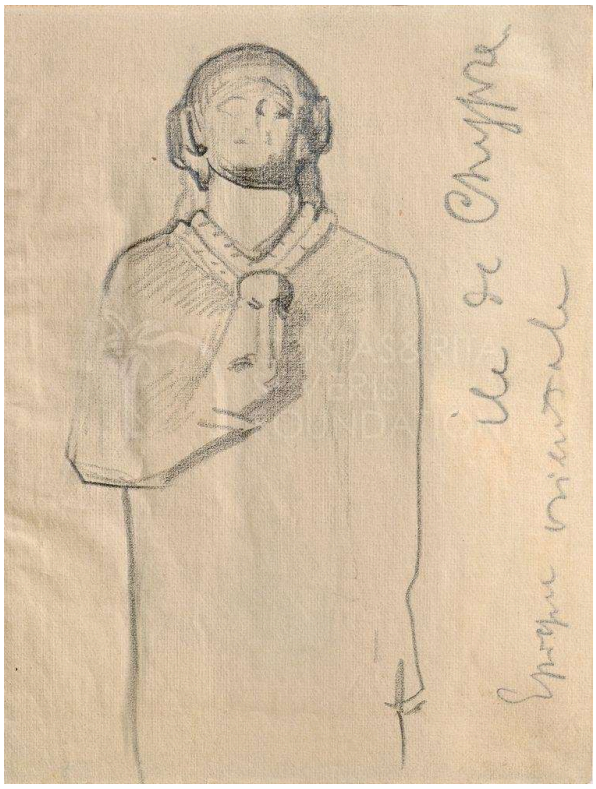
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00030

20 / 20

Ancient Statue

Léon Bakst

1921 · Pencil · Centre of Visual Arts and Research



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Drawing and annotation share this small sheet from Bakst's 1921 visit. The frontal statue's pose is reduced to a few contours, including a hand held toward the chest. The CVAR connects his Cypriot studies with costume work, a reminder that a travel sketch can become material for later invention as well as a record of an encountered object.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PNT-00043-01

A picture is one kind of record

Follow the object links for inscriptions and catalogue information, particularly when a building's name or attribution is uncertain. Present-day place names, access and condition need separate checking. The selection describes collection records rather than a current hanging, and permission to reproduce an image must be checked independently of permission to visit the museum.

Further reading

Our Home in Cyprus

Esmé Scott-Stevenson (1880) · Free digitized English edition through Google Books; availability and sign-in requirements can vary.

Scott-Stevenson, whose landscape appears in this guide, also wrote about living and travelling in Cyprus. Her book is a historical source shaped by a British colonial viewpoint. Read its descriptions alongside the pictures, asking whose activities and perspectives remain outside each account.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12
